



Air University
Mid Semester Examinations: Spring 2026

Student ID: 233079

Subjective Part
(To be solved on Answer Books only)

Subject: Cyber Threat Intelligence
Class: BSCYS
Section(s): VI-B
Course Code: CY-429

Time Allowed: 2 hours
Max Marks: 50
FM's Name: Eman Munir
FM's Signature: *Eman*

INSTRUCTIONS

- Attempt responses on the answer book only.
- Nothing is to be written on the question paper.
- Rough work or writing on question paper will be considered as use of unfair means.

Q. No. 1 (CLO 1)		Marks
a	You receive three separate incident reports from three different companies in your ISAC over six weeks. Each mention: Bulgarian-hosted VPS, Let's Encrypt certificates, Cobalt Strike beaconing every 60 seconds, and spear phishing lures targeting CFOs. The malware hashes are all different. Do these belong to the same actor? Make the call and defend it using specific clustering criteria. What is the one thing that, if confirmed, would most increase your confidence; and what is the one thing that would make you split them into two clusters?	15
Q. No. 2 (CLO 2)		
	Your CISO asks: "What percentage of our detections would catch APT29 if they hit us today?" You have 300 SIEM rules, no ATT&CK coverage map, and access to ATT&CK Navigator. Walk through exactly what you do over the next two days to produce an honest answer. What result do most organizations find when they do this exercise for the first time and what would you tell the CISO if the number is lower than expected?	15
	A TI vendor is pitching your CISO. They claim: "We deliver 10 million IOCs daily, updated in real time, with global coverage." Your CISO turns to you and asks what you think. You have 60 seconds. What are the two questions you ask the vendor out loud and what answer to each would make you recommend walking away immediately?	10

	Q. No. 3 (CLO 1)	Mar
	Three weeks ago, you pushed a high-confidence STIX Indicator SDO (confidence: 90) for an APT29 PowerShell pattern into your TAXII server. It has been auto-ingested by your SIEM and is actively blocking. Today, you confirm the actor has rotated infrastructure and changed their execution method, the pattern now generates false positives on legitimate admin scripts. What do you do to the STIX object, in what order, and what happens downstream in the SIEM? What is the one field that, if you had set it correctly from the start, would have handled part of this automatically?	10

*****End of Question Paper*****